



Case Study: Thales

Taking pipeline ownership in regulated EMEA aerospace

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How I'll Sell — The GitLab Way

C Collaboration

Pod-selling. Solutions
Architect on every Thales
call from week one.

R Results

Coverage beats activity.
By week four, Jordan
Dubié and two dev leads
in Salesforce.

E Efficiency

First email to Thales is a
link to the GitLab
Handbook. If they read it,
half my discovery is done.

D Diversity

Thales runs 68 countries
— 68 buying cultures. I
sell to the room I'm in.

I Iteration

Six weeks of Proof of
Concept on one Toulouse
team beats six months of
slide decks.

T Transparency

Send Jordan the discount
math up front. Trust beats
tactics on renewal.

Not a sales playbook. This is how GitLab works — and how I want to sell.



Company Profile: Thales

Aerospace, defense & digital security.

Software is now strategic.

Thales built hardware for 125 years. Now their satellites, defense systems, and digital ID products are software-defined — and the dev org is scaling fast.

The toolchain underneath — Bitbucket, Jenkins, Jira, SonarQube, Fortify — was stitched together when Thales was smaller. It cannot carry where they are going.

That's the opening.

Quick facts

~81,000 employees

68 countries

~5,000 DevSecOps users

20x faster pipeline cycles

8x more deployments

INDUSTRY Aerospace · Defense · Digital Security

HQ Paris, France · Listed Euronext



The Opportunity

Not a Bitbucket renewal. A platform consolidation hiding inside one.

Pain Thales feels today

- 5,000 devs across 7 tool silos.
- Compliance evidence = quarterly fire drill.
- Every M&A adds another stack.

Signals between the lines

- DevSecOps team 3× in 18 months.
- Bitbucket renewal in 9 months.
- CISO is public on Software Bill of Materials.

My wedge: The Software Bill of Materials mandate. It's the one initiative no one can deprioritize — and GitLab is the only single-app answer.



Stakeholder Map

CHAMPION

Jordan Dubié

Chief Product Owner

Public GitLab fan. Start here.

ECONOMIC BUYER

Nicolas Fernandez

Group CTO, Vélizy HQ

TCO. Hates wrong Power BI slide.

RISK GATE

Group CISO

name TBC · validate week 1

Software Bill of Materials = headache. GitLab takes it.

Two names verified. Risk Gate 1 map week 1.

Engagement Plan

First 90 days. No miracles, just rhythm.

Week 1–2 · Listen

Jordan + 3 dev leads. No pitch.

Week 3–6 · Frame

Software Bill of Materials workshop with the CISO.

Week 7–12 · Prove

POC: one Toulouse team. 6 weeks.

Week 12+ · Expand

Toulouse → Vélizy → Spain. Reference, then roll.



Why GitLab Wins at Thales

GitLab

The platform — not the stack.

- ✓ Single application
- ✓ Self-managed for sovereignty
- ✓ Software Bill of Materials native
- ✓ Cultural operating system

GitHub + Actions

A stack you stitch together.

- ✗ Limited self-hosting
- ✗ Software Bill of Materials
= paid tier

Azure DevOps

4 SKUs, multiple UIs.

- ✗ Cloud-first only
- ✗ Software Bill of Materials
via Defender

The call: GitLab Ultimate is 1 license. The competition is 4 SKUs across 2 vendors.





Thank you.

Pipeline ownership. Day
one.